



1662

PALACE OF THE SUN KING

In 1661, 22-year-old King Louis XIV took charge of France ruling as the “Sun King”, an absolute monarch, accepting no limit to his God-given authority. To express his vision of royal power, he ordered the construction of a palace at Versailles, outside Paris, as a new seat for his court. The magnificent buildings and gardens were mostly completed by the late 1680s.

◁ *Palace of Versailles*,
Pierre Patel, 1668

“L’Etat, c’est moi” (“I am the State”)

ATTRIBUTED TO KING LOUIS XIV

1660

1661 The Slave Code
enacted in British
Barbados denies enslaved
people any rights



△ 17th-century map showing Formosa



1662

KOXINGA RULES FORMOSA

Supporters of the Ming dynasty resisted the Manchu takeover of China for many years. In 1661, Ming loyalist and pirate Zheng Chenggong (Koxinga), defeated in mainland China, led his followers to Formosa (Taiwan). Capturing the Dutch fort on the island, in 1662 he set up his own kingdom as a Ming loyalist base. Koxinga’s successors held Formosa until it finally fell to the Qing in 1683.

◁ *Koxinga (Zheng Chenggong)*